DIGITAL LITERACY

PROJECT REPORT FILE

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Course: Digital Literacy

Course Code: CSE0001

Task 1

Canva Infographic – Digital Literacy Awareness

Overview
For this project, Canva was chosen as the primary tool to create a visual resource promoting digital literacy awareness among students. Canva is a free, web-based graphic design platform that allows users to produce professional-quality designs without prior design experience, making it ideal for academic projects.

Infographic Design
A one-page infographic was created using Canva to present key concepts of digital literacy in a clear and engaging way. The infographic covered the following areas:

- What is Digital Literacy?
- Why it Matters
- Useful Digital Tools
- Safe Internet Practices
- Email Etiquette
- Professional Online Presence

Design Approach
Special attention was given to:

- Maintaining a clear and logical visual structure
- Keeping content simple and easy to understand
- Breaking information into concise, digestible sections

This ensured that the main ideas were highlighted effectively without overwhelming the reader.

Learning Outcome
The project involved turning detailed information into visually appealing and easy-to-understand content, an important skill for academic presentations and assignments. It also emphasized the value of design in enhancing communication.

Conclusion
Creating the infographic demonstrated how visuals can communicate information more effectively than plain text. This experience helped build confidence in using Canva for future academic and professional projects.

Task 2

Portfolio

Building a Professional Online Presence

In today's digitally connected world, cultivating a professional online presence is just as important as academic success. Platforms like LinkedIn, Kaggle, and ResearchGate offer students and professionals opportunities to showcase their skills, network with peers, and engage with their fields beyond the classroom. Learning to navigate and use these platforms effectively is a key part of modern digital literacy.

LinkedIn
LinkedIn is the largest professional networking platform globally, providing students with a space to create a digital resume, connect with industry professionals, and explore internship and job opportunities. For college students, LinkedIn acts as a bridge between academic life and the professional world. It allows users to follow companies, interact with industry content, receive mentorship, and even be discovered by recruiters. A well-crafted LinkedIn profile can open doors that a traditional resume alone might not.

Kaggle
Kaggle is a platform designed for data science and machine learning enthusiasts. It offers datasets, coding competitions, and community notebooks where students can practice real-world problem-solving and demonstrate technical skills. Engaging in Kaggle competitions or publishing notebooks helps build a visible portfolio, enhancing employability in tech and data science fields. For students interested in AI, data analytics, or research, Kaggle provides a hands-on learning environment.

ResearchGate
ResearchGate is a professional network for researchers, academics, and scientists. It allows users to share research papers, track ongoing studies, and collaborate with peers worldwide. For college students involved in research projects or academic writing, ResearchGate offers access to a vast library of published work and opportunities to connect directly with experts in their field.

Together, LinkedIn, Kaggle, and ResearchGate address different aspects of professional and academic growth: LinkedIn for career networking, Kaggle for technical skill development, and ResearchGate for academic research engagement. Consistent and genuine participation on these platforms can greatly enhance a student's professional identity over time.

Task 3A

Hackerrank

HackerRank is an online platform where programmers and students can practice coding, solve challenges, and get certified in various technical skills. It's widely used by both students looking to improve and companies looking to hire. It offers coding challenges across multiple programming languages, skill certifications, interview preparation and competition. I believe it to be an immensely useful tool for students, as the exercises themselves are short and quick, offering students the opportunity to to be consistent while also learning and improving their skills in programming.

Task 3B

Using G Suite for Digital Literacy Awareness

Google Forms was used in this project to create an interactive Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz aimed at testing students' understanding of basic digital concepts and safe online behavior. Google Forms is part of the G-Suite ecosystem and is widely used for surveys, quizzes, and data collection due to its simplicity and seamless integration with other Google tools. Each question was crafted to be straightforward yet thought-provoking, encouraging students to reflect on their own digital habits. Once the form was created, it was linked to Google Sheets, which automatically collected and organized every response as it came in. This integration allowed for real-time tracking of results, making it easy to review how students answered, identify which concepts were least understood, and draw simple conclusions about the overall level of digital awareness. The experience demonstrated how two tools within the same suite can work together seamlessly, one for collecting data and the other for organizing and analyzing it. Working with Google Forms and Google Sheets together provided a practical understanding of how digital tools can be used for research and data collection. The ability to gather responses and instantly analyze them in a spreadsheet is a skill that will be valuable for future academic surveys, research projects, and collaborative work.

Task 4 Email Etiquette

Task 4A: Sample Emails reflecting proper Email etiquette

Email is one of the most important forms of professional communication, and knowing how to write one correctly is a skill every college student needs. A poorly written email can create a bad impression, while a well-crafted one reflects maturity and professionalism.

A professional email should always begin with a clear subject line that tells the reader exactly what the email is about. The greeting should be respectful and addressed correctly for example "Dear Professor XYX" rather than "Hey" or no greeting at all. The body should be short and to the point, stating the purpose clearly without unnecessary detail. Proper grammar and spelling are essential, abbreviations like "u", "plz", or "thx" have no place in professional correspondence. Always close with a polite sign-off like "Regards" or "Thank you", followed by your full name. Replying within 24 hours is also considered good email practice.

Good email etiquette is a simple habit that goes a long way in building a professional reputation. Developing it early in college ensures smoother communication with professors, recruiters, and collaborators throughout academic and professional life.

Task 4B: Hypothetical Situation About Poor Digital Communication

A situation where poor digital communication can cause problems is when an intern sends an email to their supervisor using informal language and unclear instructions.

For example, if the email has no proper subject line, greeting, or clear explanation of the task, the supervisor may misunderstand the message or miss important details. This can delay the work and affect the overall progress of the project, creating confusion within the team.

This situation could have been avoided by writing a clear and professional email with a proper subject line, polite greeting, and brief but complete explanation of the task. Using simple and respectful language, along with clear instructions, helps ensure that the message is understood correctly.

Good digital communication makes teamwork smoother and prevents unnecessary delays in academic and professional environments.

Task 5A: Case Study

The case study I took is a hypothetical situation that examines a UPI payment fraud incident through the fictional story of Riya, a college student who lost ₹18,000 while trying to sell her laptop online. By disguising a payment request as a money transfer, the scammer exploited a simple gap in Riya's understanding of how UPI works. Despite filing a complaint on cybercrime.gov.in and calling helpline 1930, recovery of her money was not guaranteed. The case demonstrates how financial fraud does not always involve hacking or complex technology, sometimes a single moment of unawareness is all it takes. Being digitally literate goes beyond knowing how to use a smartphone or browse the internet. It means understanding the tools, platforms, and transactions that have become a part of daily life, and recognizing when something isn't right. A basic awareness of how UPI requests work, what phishing looks like, or how to verify a suspicious link can be the difference between staying safe and becoming a victim.

Task 5B: Prevention Checklist

The Stay Safe Online checklist is a practical guide designed to help individuals protect themselves from common cyber threats. It is divided into two sections, General Online Safety and Financial & UPI Safety, covering eight actionable tips relevant to students in India. The general safety tips address everyday risks such as weak passwords, phishing links, unsafe public Wi-Fi, and oversharing on social media. The financial safety section focuses on UPI fraud, highlighting that receiving money never requires a PIN and that scammers often use near-identical UPI IDs to deceive users. Emergency reporting channels, cybercrime.gov.in and helpline 1930, are included to ensure students know exactly where to turn if something goes wrong. Rather than just raising awareness, the checklist gives students concrete, easy-to-follow steps to stay safe online in their day-to-day lives.

Conclusion

This project was an exploration of digital literacy in its truest sense not just understanding what digital tools are, but actively using them, reflecting on their purpose, and recognizing their role in everyday academic and professional life. Across the five tasks, each activity contributed a distinct dimension to this understanding. Designing the infographic on Canva demonstrated how information, when presented thoughtfully, can educate and engage far more effectively than plain text. Building a presence on platforms like LinkedIn, Kaggle, and ResearchGate revealed that a student's digital identity extends well beyond the classroom, and that the foundations of a professional reputation can be laid long before graduation. Practicing on HackerRank reinforced the value of consistency and hands-on learning in developing technical skills. Using Google Forms and Sheets together showed how seamlessly digital tools can work in tandem for data collection and analysis. Finally, studying email etiquette through both best practices and a hypothetical failure made it clear that how we communicate digitally is just as important as what we communicate. What this project ultimately highlighted is that digital literacy is not a single skill but a collection of habits, awareness, and tools that together shape how effectively a person navigates the modern world. For college students especially, developing these habits early creates a strong foundation not just for academic success, but for a confident, capable, and safe digital life. In a world that is only becoming more connected, being digitally literate is no longer an advantage. It is a necessity.